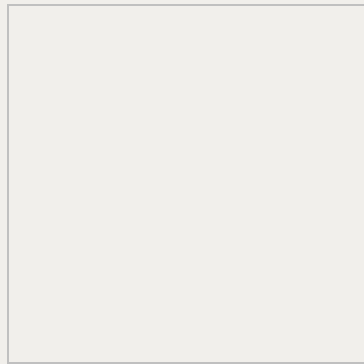


IN CONTEXT

Musical nationalism

Dvořák was powerfully influenced by the cultural nationalism that was sweeping through Europe during the second half of the 19th century. This was arguably pioneered by Chopin—who brought the language of Polish folk dances into Parisian salons—and by Liszt, who transformed gypsy music into a recognizably Hungarian national style. The trend spread to Russia (via the five composers known simply as The Five or the Mighty Handful), Norway (via Grieg), and Czechoslovakia, where it had been championed by Smetana before Dvořák. The legends that Dvořák loved and turned into symphonic poems and operas were deeply connected to the folk music he had heard in childhood, plus the natural beauty of Bohemia.



TITLE PAGE OF DVORAK'S SLAVIC DANCE MUSIC DUMKA AND
FURIANT, OP. 12

Antonín Dvořák's music strikes a unique balance between Classical forms and folk dances, between grand-scale visions and intimacy, and between laughter and tears. Inspired by wide-ranging influences, wrapped up in a distinctive musical voice, it